ERSEA Annual Training

Eligibility, Recruitment, Selection, Enrollment and Attendance



PORTLAND
Public Schools

Eligibility

In order to enroll in Portland Public Schools PreK children must:

- Live within the PPS School District boundaries, east of the Willamette River
- Be 3 or 4 years old by September 1st
- Be determined eligible (some priority populations include low SES, experiencing homelessness, receiving SNAP/TANF/SSI, in foster/kinship care, refugee status)
- Income based eligibility:
  - Families under 130% are eligible for all three funding streams.
  - Families under 200% are eligible for Preschool Promise and Preschool for All
  - Families over 200% are eligible for Preschool for All.



Recruitment

- Recruitment is a year-round, team supported activity
- Community Needs Assessment (updated annually) is used to identify key recruitment areas
- Some ways we recruit for our waiting list:
  - Posters at PPS schools
  - District Comms supporting community messaging
  - Community partner notifications
  - Banners and A-frame signs at all sites
  - Community resources fairs and networking events
  - Social media/Website updates
  - Open House events at all locations
  - Word of mouth through current and past enrolled families

Selection

We focus on enrolling children with the least access to quality preschool and have several priority populations. Once applications are submitted they are placed on a weighted wait list based on the information provided. We do not enroll on a first come, first served basis. Our selection criteria are approved annually but our Parent Policy Council and governing board (PPS School Board).

Examples of priority populations that increase enrollment potential:

- Children experiencing homelessness
- Children in foster care
- Children with developmental disabilities
- Children of color (specifically Black, African, Refugee, Latinx, American Indian or Alaska Native)
- Children who speak English as a second language
- Children who have experienced trauma

Early Learners

2026-27 Selection Criteria

AREA	DESCRIPTION	POINTS
Early Intervention		
Diagnosed Condition	MECP	10
No EI needs	None	00
Income		(auto assigned in CP)
Under 100% of FPL	Elig	200
Public Assistance	TANF/SSI	200
Foster Child	Foster	200
Verified Homeless	Homeless	200
100-130% of FPL	130%	100
130-200% of FPL	200%	50
Over 200% of FPL	Over	00
Other Factors		(entered by FA team)
Transfer from other HS or EHS	Tran or EHS	75
Referral from another agency	Ref	50
Sibling enrolled in last 5 years	Sib	10
Other environmental factors: former or current parental incarceration, divorce, drug/alcohol addiction, domestic violence, child abuse/neglect, death or significant health need in household, presence of significant community violence, parent in military, unstable or poor housing conditions, or other priority population status	Need	10 pts per issue
Age		(auto assigned in CP)
Four by September 1st	Four	100
Four by December 1st	3 ½	50
Three	Three	00

Enrollment

Updates:

- During the 2025-26 SY Early Learners reached 98% enrollment, an increase of 6% over the previous two years
- The Pre K application opened March 1st, we are already enrolling families for next school year

Timeline:

- Enrollment for new children starts in March and continues through the Spring and Summer
- Enrollment for returning children starts immediately following Spring Break
- Classroom placement occurs in August

Notes on our process:

- Enrollment team supports parents through the enrollment process in order to complete all required forms
- As a part of ongoing training our team is trained on how to conduct respectful and sensitive interviews with parents during the enrollment process.
- All families receive an initial Teacher home visit before starting in the classroom

Attendance



- Our program monitors attendance regularly, following up with all families whose children are absent for more than two consecutive days to determine if supports are needed
- If a child falls below 85% attendance the Family Service Worker creates an Attendance Success Plan with the family to increase attendance
- Attendance is monitored for the program as a whole in order to address systemic or common attendance barriers for families

Questions?

Contact-Rhiannon Martin
Program Manager-Enrollment & Data
rhmartin@pps.net
971-706-1806

**Parent Policy Council and Governing Board (PPS School Board) approval is required to approve our current selection criteria.*